ExpenseMate

Mobile App Wireframing Report

A UI/UX case study on a low-fidelity expense tracking app

1. Project overview

ExpenseMate is a low-fidelity mobile expense tracker built for university students and young professionals who want a straightforward way to keep tabs on their income and spending. Rather than jumping straight into visual polish, this project focuses on the structural and experiential groundwork: how the app should feel to use, how information should flow from screen to screen, and how everyday financial habits can be turned into a few simple, repeatable actions.

The wireframe stage is intentionally rough around the edges. That roughness is the point — it lets the core interactions be tested and refined before a single pixel of visual design is committed to.

2. Basic user research

Early conversations with prospective users surfaced a consistent pattern: people don't struggle because they lack discipline; they struggle because logging expenses is inconvenient in the moment. Small transactions add up unnoticed, paper notes get lost, and by the time a monthly budget check comes around, the picture is incomplete.

Recurring pain points identified during research:

- Forgetting to record day-to-day purchases, especially small cash transactions
- No easy way to see how monthly spending compares against a budget
- Reliance on paper notes or scattered mental math
- A desire for a tool that takes seconds to use, not minutes

These findings shaped a clear design goal: minimize the effort between "I just spent money" and "that expense is logged."

3. User persona

Attribute	Detail
Name	Ibtida Ara
Age	23
Occupation	University student
Goals	Track daily expenses, build a saving habit, and stay within a monthly budget
Pain points	Forgets to log expenses, currently relies on paper notes, wants something simple and fast

Ibtida represents the core target user: someone motivated to manage money better but held back by tools that feel like extra work rather than support.

4. User flow

The navigation structure was designed to feel like a short, predictable loop rather than a maze. A new user should be able to reach the dashboard quickly, and a returning user should be able to log a transaction in just a couple of taps.

Example:

Splash → Login → Dashboard → Add Expense / Add Income → Save → Transaction History

Each step in this flow was chosen deliberately. The dashboard acts as the home base, giving an at-a-glance summary before the user drills into logging a transaction or reviewing history. Reports and Profile sit one tap away from the dashboard, keeping deeper functionality accessible without cluttering the main screen.

5. Design thinking process

The wireframes were developed using the five stages of design thinking:

- **Empathize** — understand the real financial-tracking struggles users face day to day

- **Define** — frame the core problem as the need for an easy, low-friction expense tracker
- **Ideate** — explore simple navigation patterns and a fast transaction-entry flow
- **Prototype** — build low-fidelity wireframes in Figma to test structure before styling
- **Test** — walk users through common tasks and gather feedback for iteration

This process kept the focus on solving the right problem before investing time in visual design, reducing the risk of building a polished interface around a flawed structure.

6. Expected outcome

The completed wireframe set demonstrates early-stage planning and user-centered thinking through a simple, coherent navigation flow. It serves as the foundation for the next phase of the project high-fidelity UI design by validating that the underlying structure genuinely supports how someone like Ibtida wants to manage her money.